

EA Self-Diagnostic

How to Use This Diagnostic: This self-diagnostic helps you quickly assess your EA group's maturity and effectiveness. Select the value (1–5) that best reflects your agreement regarding your EA group's effectiveness across each dimension.

Agreement Scoring Scale				
5 Strongly Agree	4 Agree	3 It Depends	2 Disagree	1 Strongly Disagree

1. Build The Case For Enterprise Architecture		Agreement Score	Section Sum	Evaluation Key
	We identified a preliminary set of core objectives and activities for the EA group.			6–13 Nascent 14–23 Baseline 24–30 World Class
	We built (or updated) our EA charter in order to clarify EA's purpose across the organization and with senior management.			
	We follow key principles for effective engagement (e.g., flex EA support for business partner needs, accelerate access to EA expertise).			
	We tailor EA's engagement style to business leaders' preferences for risk, return and effort in solutions delivery projects.			
	We focus EA activity in places where the team's competencies and skills give EA a clear comparative advantage.			
	We isolate the top opportunities for EA impact (e.g., business value drivers, IT value drivers) to simplify EA's value delivery message.			
2. Define EA Services And Metrics		Agreement Score	Section Sum	Evaluation Key
	We aggregate EA activities into a small handful of EA services advertised via a service catalog.			6–13 Nascent 14–23 Baseline 24–30 World Class
	We identify customer-focused EA product offerings anchored on the jobs key stakeholders need to get done.			
	We develop marketing collateral for EA's product offerings.			
	We start with foundational EA metrics to track and refine EA program practices before adopting more mature EA performance metrics.			
	We track EA progress against metrics that reflect key stakeholders' top priorities and tailor metrics scorecards for different audiences.			
	We summarize a clear, concise, and measurable strategy that clarifies where the EA team is, where it's going and how it will get there.			

EA Self-Diagnostic (Continued)

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3. Identify EA Structure And Roles		Agreement Score	Section Sum	Evaluation Key
	We structure EA to suit our organization's structure, constraints and expectations and embed architects to aid decision making as needed.			6–13 Nascent 14–23 Baseline 24–30 World Class
	We question assumptions driving existing EA activities, and we look for new or unmet needs and priorities where EA can deliver value.			
	We identify the organization's architectural pain points and use those pain points to determine which architect roles are needed.			
	We develop architects' product management skills to better support product lines.			
	We develop current IT employees with architect potential into architects to supplement ongoing efforts to recruit experienced external candidates.			
	We built an apprenticeship program that focuses development efforts on key behaviors demonstrated by successful architects, rather than on technical expertise.			
4. Initiate Business Architecture		Agreement Score	Section Sum	Evaluation Key
	We co-create business capabilities with business partners – in particular, mid-level managers – to ensure business relevance.			6–13 Nascent 14–23 Baseline 24–30 World Class
	We consider context and investment rationale when drafting capabilities and use concise statements to ensure model consumability.			
	We assess capabilities' strategic importance and overall performance in terms of enabling people, process, information and technology.			
	We assess capability performance and identify capability gaps using a variety of approaches, including information health and business scenarios.			
	We promote business capabilities as a means to drive business outcomes and consistently use them to facilitate planning conversations.			
	We prioritize capabilities with business leaders, establish capability targets and clearly outline investments needed to advance prioritized capabilities.			

EA Self-Diagnostic (Continued)

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5. Establish Investment Planning Processes		Agreement Score	Section Sum	Evaluation Key
	We focus on understanding business goals and objectives to identify the IT initiatives needed to close capability gaps.			6–13 Nascent 14–23 Baseline 24–30 World Class
	We use capability roadmaps to coordinate investment planning across business units and product lines.			
	We define key performance metrics and benchmark roadmap progress against them.			
	We use a simple framework to assess and communicate architecture debt to business partners and project leaders.			
	We facilitate widespread API access, creation and sharing to enable interoperability.			
	We make business value – not operational efficiency – the first consideration of hosting decisions.			
6. Establish Lightweight Governance		Agreement Score	Section Sum	Evaluation Key
	We use a triage process to limit EA involvement to the most risky, complex or business critical projects.			6–13 Nascent 14–23 Baseline 24–30 World Class
	We have formal mechanisms in place to accelerate governance without sacrificing quality of project reviews.			
	We identify and develop existing IT resources for delegate architects to provide flex capacity and do architecture work on EA's behalf.			
	We offer courses and tools to help the extended IT development and delivery community make sound architecture decisions more autonomously.			
	We create tools that help users meet their speed objectives and make adherence to architectural guidance an easy choice.			
	We embed and automate governance into automated build environments to make governance adherence easy to apply.			

EA Self-Diagnostic (Continued)

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7. Support Distributed Delivery		Agreement Score	Section Sum	Evaluation Key
	We co-create and co-manage RAs with SMEs across the enterprise to ensure RAs are consumable by varied audiences and to expand RA scope.			6–13 Nascent 14–23 Baseline 24–30 World Class
	We apply brand management techniques (e.g., reinforcing key messages centered on benefits) to socialize RAs, drive use and enhance their value.			
	We make RA-compliant application building blocks available for developer self-service to enable speed, architectural soundness and scalability.			
	We use formalized assessment processes to calibrate levels of governance oversight and EA support to the proficiency and needs of individual teams.			
	We build a diverse portfolio of platforms to support the widely varied digital needs and technical proficiency of the entire developer community.			
	We offer standard delivery services and value-added features in platform services to support developers, speed delivery and reduce complexity.			
8. Support Business-Led Technology Decisions		Agreement Score	Section Sum	Evaluation Key
	We assist with innovation activities at the steps where EA can disproportionately impact technology experimentation outcomes.			6–13 Nascent 14–23 Baseline 24–30 World Class
	We use social engagement to make it easy for teams throughout the company to request architects' input on new technology ideas.			
	We match technologies to business needs by creating a formal incubation process, such as fit-for-purpose or proof-of-concept processes.			
	We support scenario-based and trigger-based strategic planning approaches that enable responsiveness to business environment changes.			
	We provide digital consulting to business partners leaders and drive consistent decision-making across PLs using the lens of cross-cutting CX.			
	We frame EA recommendations as choices – rather than imperatives – cast in terms of business outcomes.			